

Tablet App for Mac

User manual · Version 27

macOS 15 or later, Apple silicon · 2026-11-14

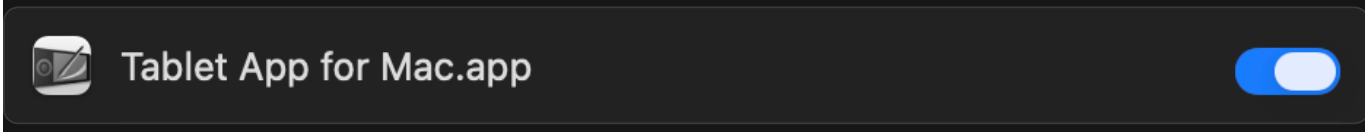
App version 26. British English. Screens are real screenshots from a Mac; a few come from earlier versions, so some may differ slightly.

Before you start

Tested only on an Apple silicon Mac with macOS 27.0.1 and a Wacom Intuos4 Small (PTK-440). Other systems and tablets are untested. Use at your own risk.

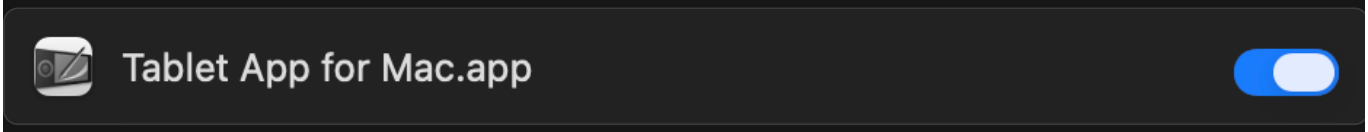
Quick start

- Quit the Wacom driver if it is running (see Wacom driver conflict).
- If the Wacom driver is installed, remove it first with Wacom's own uninstaller (Applications › Wacom Tablet › Wacom Tablet Utility › Tablet Software › Uninstall), then restart your Mac. The app warns you if it still finds it, but never removes it itself.
- Open Tablet App for Mac. The setup window **Set up Tablet App for Mac** guides you through the permissions.
- On **Let the app read your pen**, click **Open Input Monitoring**. In System Settings › Privacy & Security › **Input Monitoring**, turn on Tablet App for Mac. A **Why:** line under the step explains this: macOS lets an app read a tablet only with Input Monitoring, and the app uses it to read your pen, ExpressKeys and Touch Ring.



Input Monitoring, with the switch for Tablet App for Mac turned on

- On **Let the pen move the pointer**, click **Open Device Control and Data Access** (called **Accessibility** on older macOS). In System Settings › Privacy & Security › **Accessibility** (called **Device Control and Data Access** on macOS 27), turn on Tablet App for Mac. The **Why:** line explains that macOS lets an app move the pointer, click and press keys only with this permission, and the app uses it to turn your pen and buttons into pointer moves, clicks and shortcuts. Then click **Restart the app**.



Device Control and Data Access, with the switch for Tablet App for Mac turned on

- If the pen draws in Scribble but the pointer doesn't move, Accessibility is missing. Home shows **Open Device Control and Data Access** (called Accessibility on older macOS).
- On **Home**, check the tablet card shows your tablet as connected.
- Open the tablet, choose **Pen** in the Tool row, and set **Tip Feel**.
- Set **Mapping** to the display you draw on.
- Under **Functions**, set the ExpressKeys and the **Touch Ring** modes.
- Click **Save** in the footer. Unsaved changes are kept and offered again after a shutdown.
- Test in **Scribble**.

Introduction and requirements

Tablet App for Mac sets up a pen tablet on macOS: pen feel, buttons, mapping, ExpressKeys and Touch Ring modes, with per-app settings. Tablet input comes from the tablet driver, built on OpenTabletDriver, which the app starts.

- A Mac with Apple silicon.
- macOS 15 or later (the versions .NET 10 supports: 15, 26 and 27).
- The tablet driver, built on OpenTabletDriver (included in the app).
- Input Monitoring and Accessibility permissions (Accessibility is called Device Control and Data Access on macOS 27).
- Uninstall the Wacom driver first, as both can't run at once.

Install and first launch

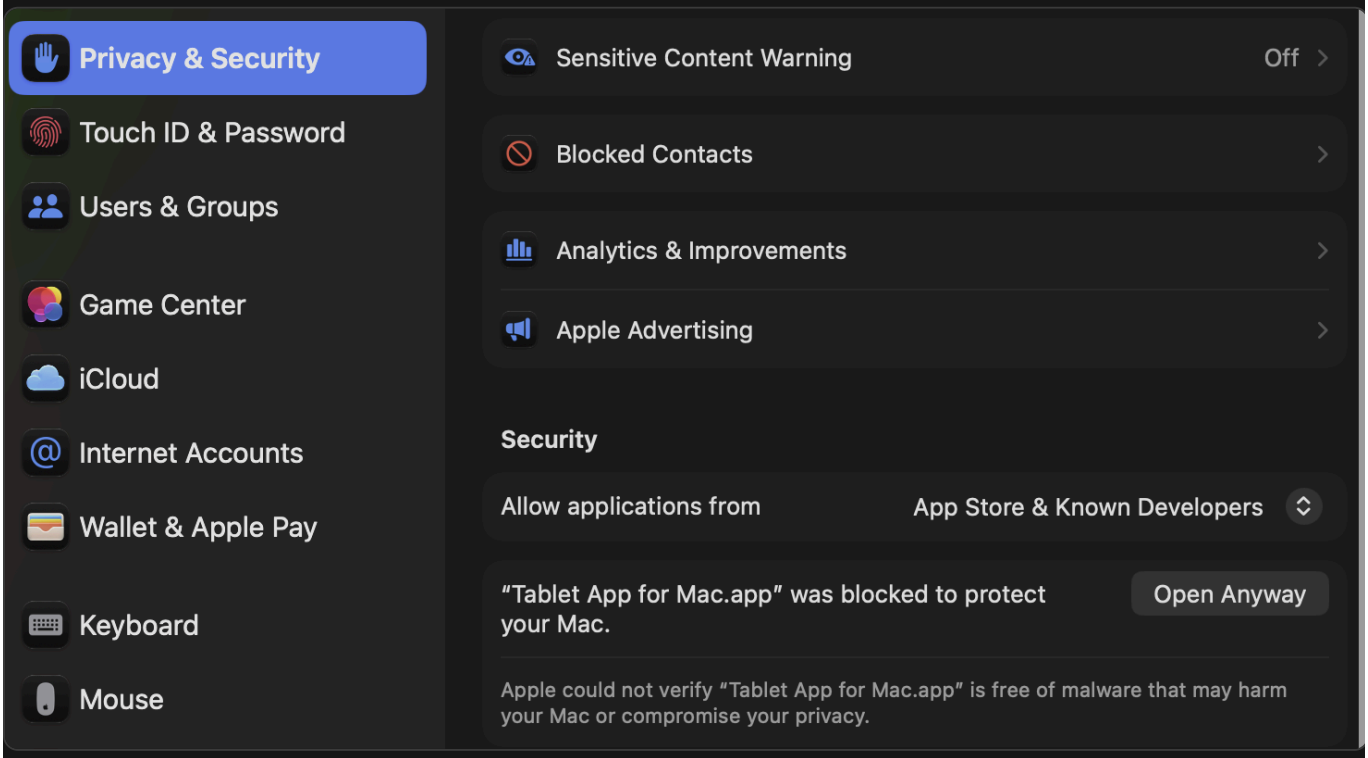
The two permissions (Input Monitoring and Accessibility) are needed only at the first installation. The setup window guides you. From Version 18 on, updates keep them: there is nothing to do.

1. Open **Tablet-App-for-Mac.dmg** and drag **Tablet App for Mac** onto the **Applications** folder. 2. Open the app from Applications. The first time, your Mac may say the app was not opened. Click **Done**. Do not click **Move to Bin**.



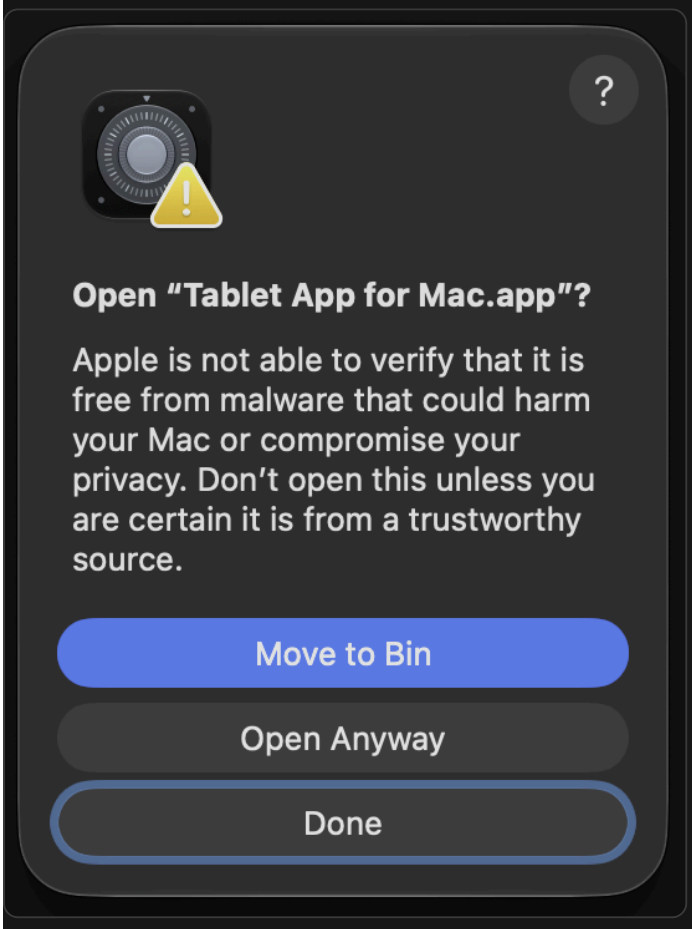
The message "Tablet App for Mac.app Not Opened", with the Done and Move to Bin buttons

3. Open **System Settings › Privacy & Security** and scroll down to **Security**. Next to "Tablet App for Mac.app was blocked to protect your Mac", click **Open Anyway**.



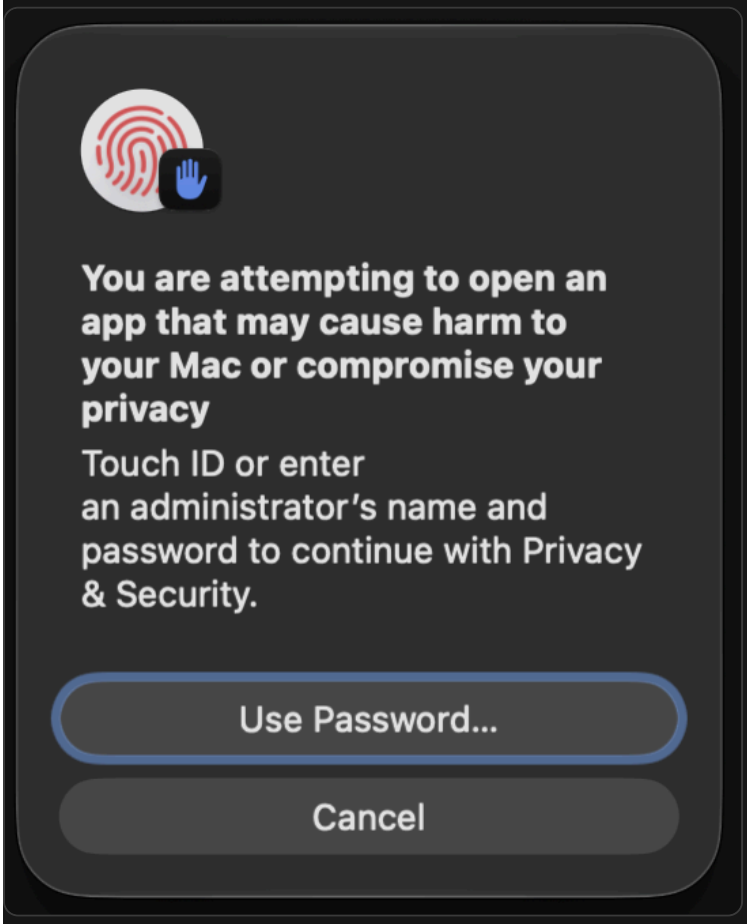
System Settings, Privacy & Security, Security section, with the Open Anyway button next to Tablet App for Mac

4. macOS asks once more. Click **Open Anyway**. Do not click the blue **Move to Bin** button.



The message "Open Tablet App for Mac.app?", with Move to Bin in blue, Open Anyway and Done

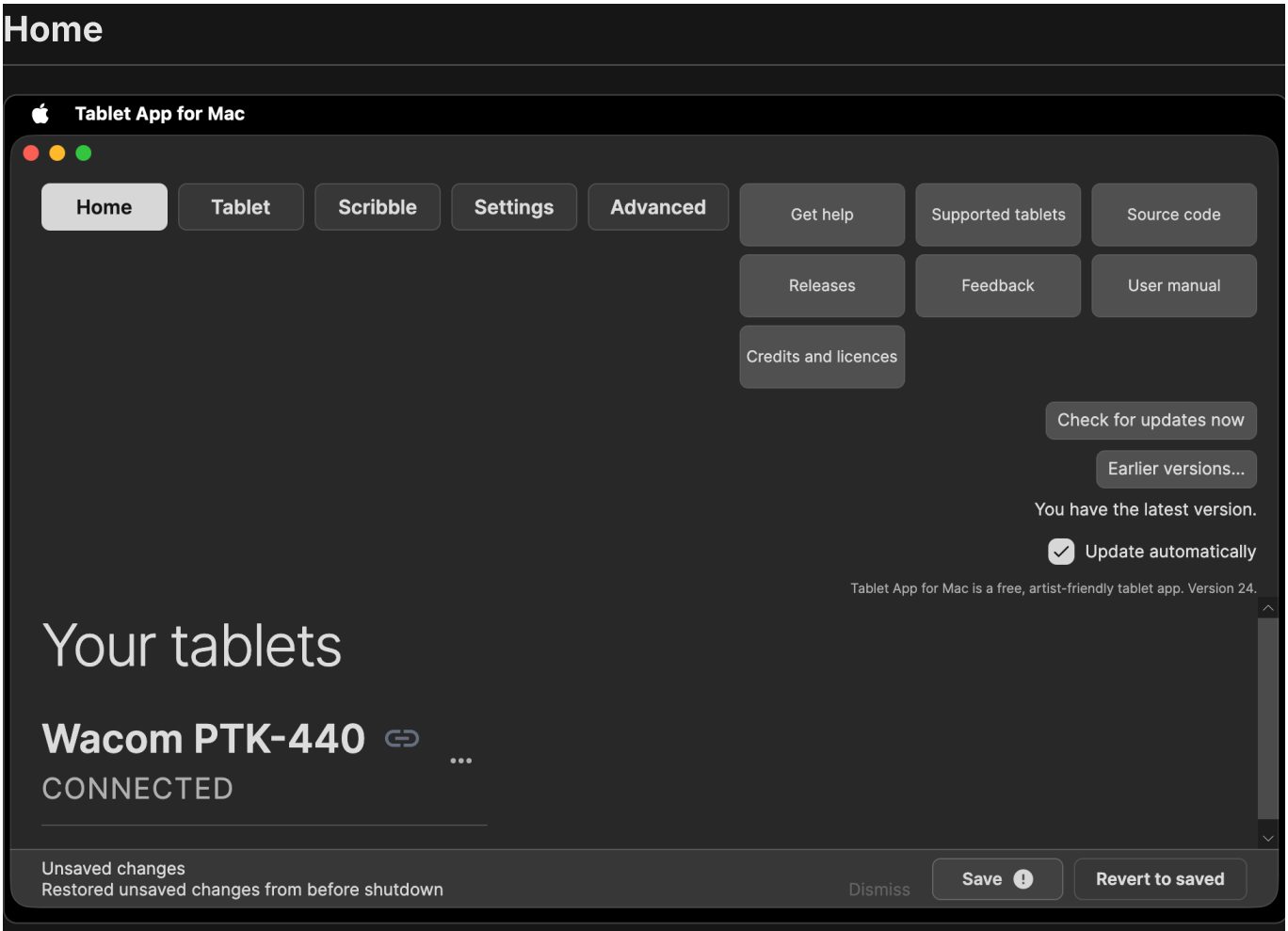
5. Confirm with Touch ID, or click **Use Password…** and enter your Mac login password. The app then opens, and macOS won't ask again.



The Touch ID prompt for Privacy & Security, with Use Password… and Cancel

- macOS asks for **Input Monitoring** (to read the pen) and **Device Control and Data Access** (called **Accessibility** on older macOS; to move the pointer and send keys and clicks). Allow both in System Settings › Privacy & Security, then relaunch the app.
- The app starts its tablet driver. The pen icon stays in the menu bar while it runs.
- To start the app when you log in, switch on **Start automatically when I log in** in **Settings › System** (or add it in System Settings › General › Login Items). At login the app starts silently: only the pen icon in the menu bar shows. Click it to open the window.
- Only one copy runs. Opening the app again brings the running copy to the front.
- To change the language, choose it under **Settings › System › Language**. **Match system** follows your Mac's language.

Home



Home

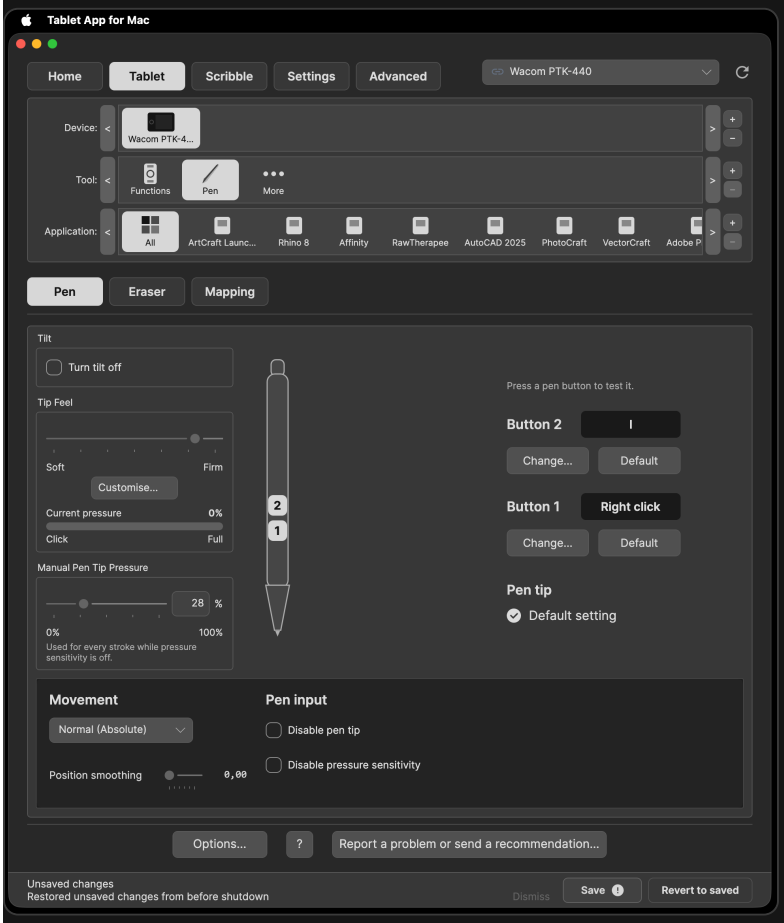
- **Your tablets**: one card per connected or remembered tablet. Click a card to open its settings.
- Card ⋯ menu: **Open tablet settings**, **Forget this tablet**.
- If a remembered tablet is not plugged in, the card tooltip says **Not detected**, and a hint reads **Not found. Double-click to see what to try.** On the tablet page a line says **Not detected. Showing this tablet's saved settings.** The help under it is: if it is plugged in, check it has power and that its USB cable goes straight into the Mac, not through a hub. Then click **Restart driver**. Still not found? **Send a report…**
- Health rows: problems found, each with **Fix** or a specific action where one exists. **Fix** works with the pen even while the pen tip or eraser is disabled.
- **Open driver page**: shown when the driver is not reachable.
- **Check for updates now** and **Earlier versions…**: see Updating.

Tablet page layout

- **Device**: the selected tablet. The switcher lists connected and remembered tablets. **+** explains how to add a tablet: connect it to your Mac and it appears in the Device row by itself. **−** forgets the selected tablet and its settings (it asks first).
- **Tool**: **Functions** (ExpressKeys, Touch ring), **Pen** (pen, eraser, mapping), a tile for each extra pen, and **More** (about, calibration, hover, filters, json). **+** explains how to add a pen: bring the new pen close to the tablet and the app adds a tile for it. **−** removes the selected extra pen's settings; the main pen can't be removed.

- **Application**: **All**, or a specific app. **+** adds apps (Command-click to choose several at once). Each added app has its own ExpressKeys, Touch Ring, pen tip and pen button actions. They switch when that app comes to the front, but only once the pen tip is lifted, so a stroke is not interrupted. Mapping and pressure stay the same for every app. **–** removes the selected app's settings; it then uses **All** again.
- **Refresh** reloads the tablet's settings from the driver.
- Footer: **Options…** (Settings), **?** (this manual), **Report a problem or send a recommendation…** (see Report a problem or send a recommendation).

Tablet › Pen



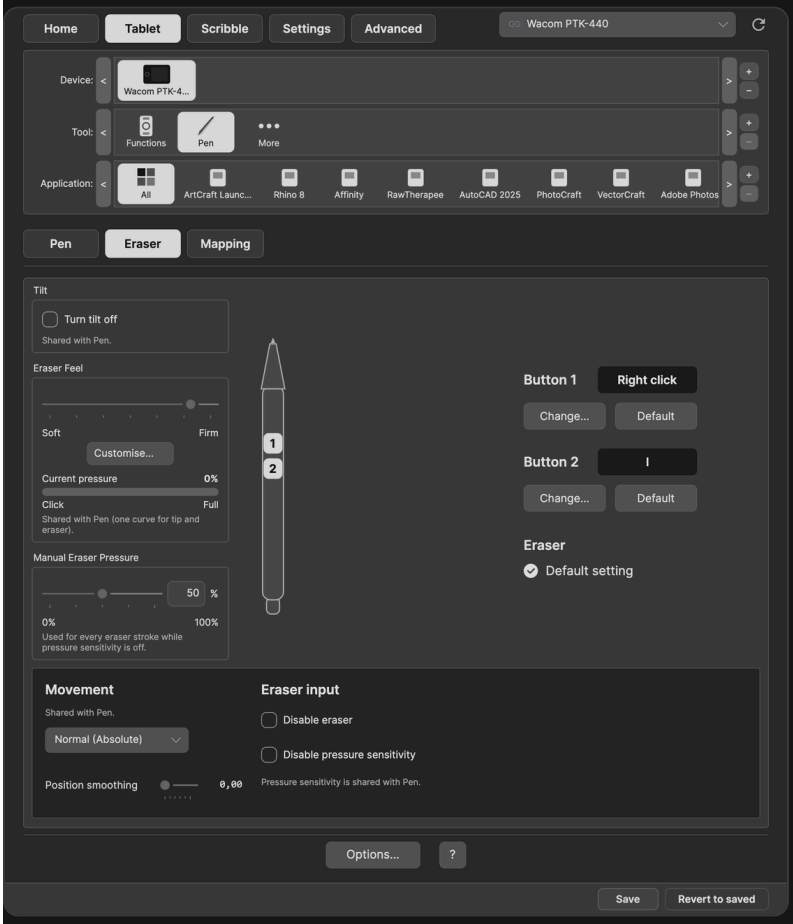
Pen

Control	Default	Function
Tilt › Turn tilt off	Off	Stops sending tilt. Shared with the eraser.
Tip Feel	Middle (linear)	Soft to Firm pressure curve.
Double Click Fix	50	How far the pen tip may wobble during a click before it counts as a drag. Off (0) turns this off for drawing apps that need every movement; Default (50) is 1 mm; 100 is 2 mm. Two tip taps close together still send a double-click.
Customise...	Closed	Shows the curve, presets **Soft**, **Linear (no curve)**, **Hard**, the input range sliders and **Cut below input minimum (dead zone)** (off).
Current pressure	Live	Pressure after the curve; tooltip shows the raw value.
Button 1 / Button 2 cards	Default (right click) / **Radial menu**	**Change...** opens the function editor; **Default** puts back the plain default (right click on button 1, middle click on button 2). Under **Mouse** you can choose **Double Click** (posts a left-button double-click at the cursor). **Radial menu** is the starting setting of pen button 2 on a new tablet and after **Restore factory settings**: press that button and a round menu opens under the pen (see Radial menu below). Choose something else under **Change...** to use button 2 for that instead.
Radial Menu Settings	Picture of the radial menu	On the right of the pen page (the pen drawing and the Button cards are next to it), always shown. **Click the picture** to open the radial menu editor for the application chosen in the Application row (the menu of the pen button that opens it, with the line **Opens with: Pen button 2** under it). If no pen button opens the radial menu, the picture is dimmed and says **No pen button opens the radial menu yet**; **Use pen button 2** makes button 2 open it (button 1 on a pen with one button). Pressing a pen button to test it works as before: its number lights on the pen picture and the line above the cards names it. Under the picture: **Menu transparency** and **Menu size**, each a slider with a number box you can type in; the picture shows both live. The picture is the menu at its **real size**, so the menu your pen opens is exactly as big as the picture (in a very narrow window the picture is shrunk to fit). **Click one of the four centre icons** in the picture (×, pencil, circular arrow, hand) to read what that button does in the real menu; it doesn't open the editor.
Pen button test	Live	Press a barrel button: its number on the pen picture lights while held, and the line above the cards reads "Button 2 pressed." (or 1).
Movement	Normal (Absolute)	**Normal (Absolute)** maps the pen to the screen. **Relative (slow / no mouse-like speed-up)**: the pointer moves from where it is, by how far the pen moves. No Mac-style speed-up. Both choices are always shown, and a saved Relative setting is never changed for you. Clicks, click-drags and a button set to **Double Click** happen at the pointer, as with a mouse. Relative mode also uses the tablet rotation set under Mapping.
Position smoothing	0.0	Steadies the cursor, with some lag. The slider is under its name and runs from 0 (off) to 10 (strongest, the old 0.25); the number is shown next to the name.
Smoother fast curves	Off	Adds smooth in-between pen points, so fast curves don't show flat pieces in drawing apps that join points with straight lines. About 5 ms of extra delay. New in Version 26.
Disable pen tip	Off	The tip makes no strokes; the bar reads 0%.

Disable pressure sensitivity	Off	Every stroke uses the Manual Pen Tip Pressure while pressed, in every app.
Manual Pen Tip Pressure	30%	Own frame under Tip Feel. The pressure used while pressure sensitivity is off (0 to 100%).

Extra pens: each pen you use on the tablet gets its own tile in the Tool row, with its own tip, eraser and side-button settings (a copy of the main pen's to start with). Tip Feel, pressure, tilt and mapping are shared by all pens.

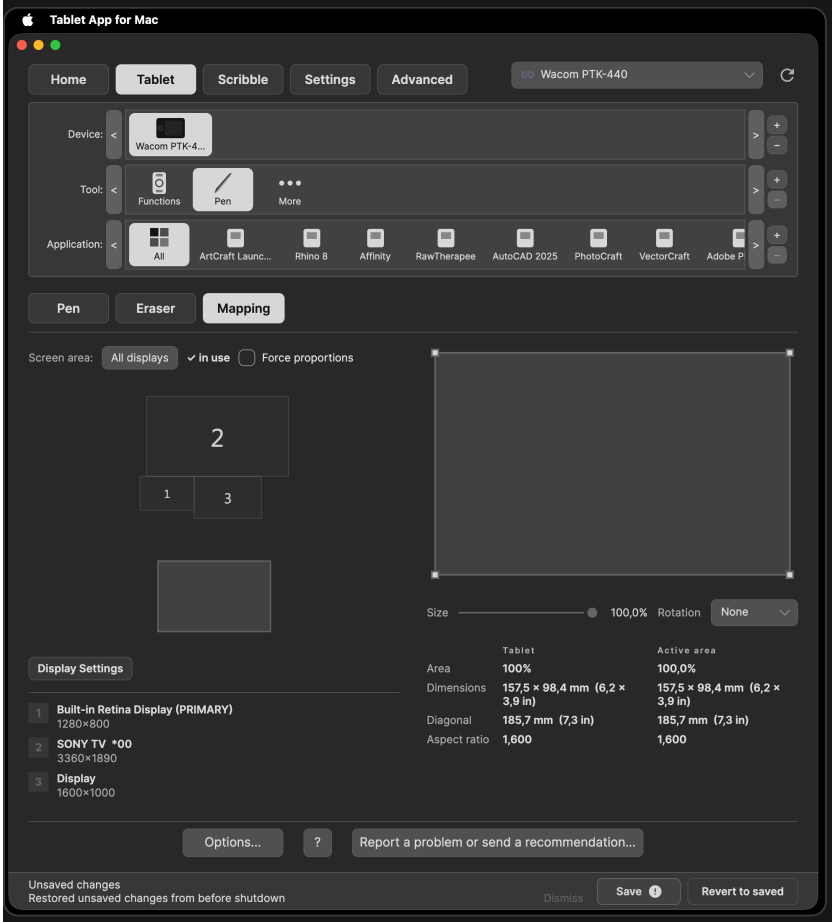
Tablet › Eraser



Eraser

The Eraser tab has the same controls as Pen. Separate for the eraser: **Disable eraser** and **Manual Eraser Pressure** (own frame under Eraser Feel; used while pressure sensitivity is off). Shared with Pen (marked "Shared with Pen"): tilt, the Feel curve (one curve for tip and eraser), pressure sensitivity, Position smoothing (and Movement, when its choice is shown). The button cards are the pen's barrel buttons.

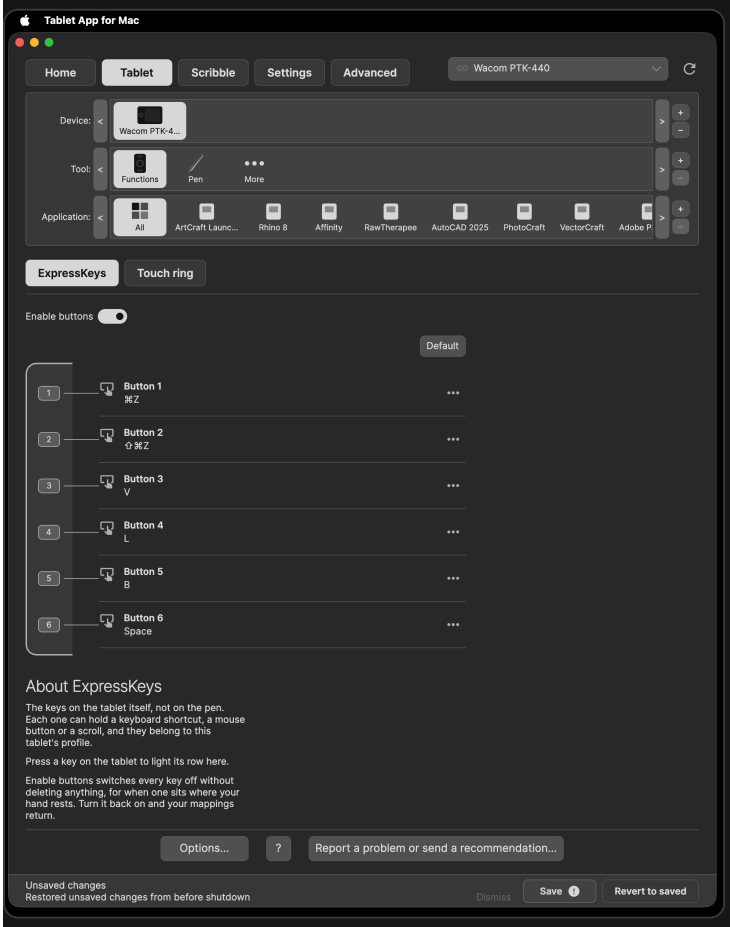
Tablet › Mapping



Mapping

Control	Default	Function
Active area	Whole tablet	Drag the area or its corners.
Rotation	0°	180° puts the ExpressKeys on the other side; 90° and 270° are portrait. This rotation is also used in Relative (slow / no mouse-like speed-up) mode. After rotating, recalibrate (More › calibration) if the pointer no longer sits under the nib.
Display / All displays	Main display	The display the area maps to.
Force proportions	On	Keeps the area at the display's aspect ratio.
Display Settings	–	Opens macOS Displays settings.

Tablet › Functions › ExpressKeys



ExpressKeys

- Press a key on the tablet to light its row.
- Row ⋯: **Edit...** opens the function editor, **Clear** removes the action, **Turn off** / **Turn on** switches just that key (an Off key is greyed and keeps its shortcut). Each application keeps its own On/Off for every key.
- **All buttons** (Off / On switch) turns every ExpressKey off or on; actions and each key's own On/Off are kept. A key works only when **All buttons** and the key are both On. While **All buttons** is Off, the per-key item is greyed ("Turn on All buttons first").
- **Default**: clears every ExpressKey action, after asking.

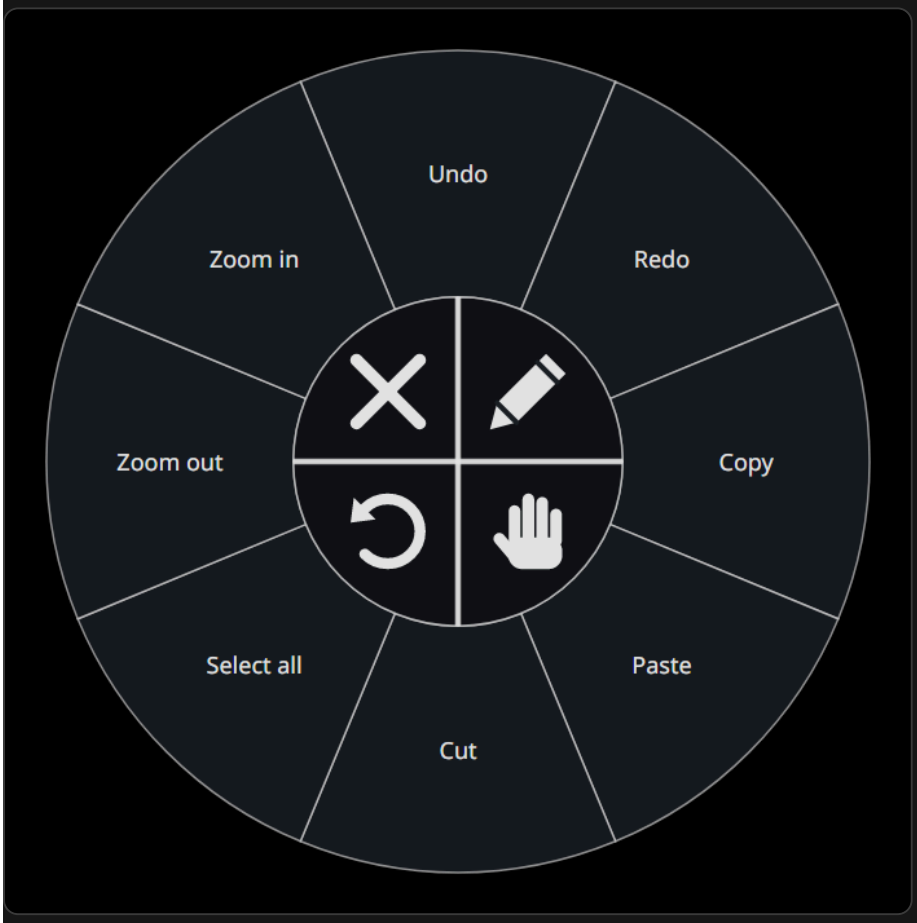
Function editor: **Keyboard** (a shortcut; Cmd, Ctrl, Shift and Option are held modifiers), **Mouse** (Left click, Right click, Middle click, Back button, Forward button, or **Double Click**), **Scroll** (up, down, left, right, or a pen gesture), **Media** (Mute, Volume down, Volume up, Play / Pause, Previous track, Next track, Stop). **Radial menu** is on its own tab (see Radial menu). **Save**, **Cancel**, **Clear**.

Pen gestures under **Scroll**, each with a **Speed** slider (Slow to Fast, 1–100, default 50):

- **Move pen to scroll**: hold the button and move the pen to scroll like a mouse wheel; the cursor stays still and the tip does not click.
- **Move pen to zoom**: hold the button and move the pen up or down to zoom. Uses Option+scroll, like the Touch Ring Zoom mode. Works in Photoshop and Affinity.
- **Move pen to pan and zoom**: hold the button and move the pen: sideways to pan, up or down to zoom. Works in Photoshop and Affinity.

Radial menu

A pen button or an ExpressKey can open a radial menu, like the one in Wacom's driver: a round menu with 8 slices, centred on the pen. **Pen button 2 opens it from the start** on a new tablet, so you can try it at once: press button 2 and tap a slice.



The radial menu: 8 slices and the four centre buttons

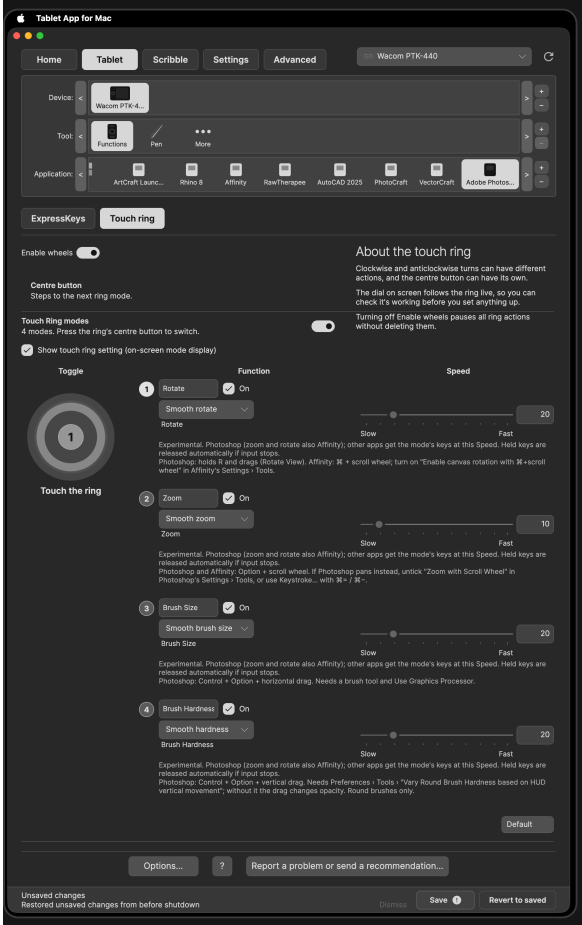
- Set it up: **Change…** on a pen button or an ExpressKey, then the **Radial menu** tab, **Save**. **Edit menu…** opens the menu editor. The Pen page also has a shortcut: **Radial Menu Settings** (see Tablet › Pen).
- Use it: press the button, then tap a slice with the pen tip. The menu closes after a choice. To use several slices in a row (for example Undo three times), hold the button while you tap. Tap the **×** in the centre, an empty slice or outside the menu, or press the button again, to close it without a choice. The pen tip never draws in your app while the menu is open. A menu left open closes by itself after a minute.
- The **centre** has four buttons, each with its own highlight under the pen or the pointer: **× (top left)** closes the menu. **Pencil (top right)**: tap it, then tap a slice, and choose what that slice does from the same choices as **Edit menu…**; the change is saved at once and the menu stays open (tap the pencil again to put it down). **Circular arrow (bottom left)** asks "Restore the 8 default slices?": tap **Yes** (right) or **No** (left). **Open hand (bottom right)**: press it with the pen tip or the mouse and move more than a few points to drag the menu somewhere else; a press that doesn't move does nothing. A menu you have moved stays until you close it.
- With the **Mac mouse**: click a slice to run it in the app underneath; the menu stays open, so you can open it with the pen and then use your 8 commands with the mouse. Click the **×**, or press **Esc**, to

close it. Slices that click the mouse need the pen. The menu does not take the keyboard from your drawing app.
- **Edit a slice**: tap the **pencil**, then tap a slice (with the pen **or** with the Mac mouse) and its editor opens. While you are choosing, the hint **Edit the slice you tap next** is shown next to the menu (under it) and stays until you pick a slice or tap the pencil again; it no longer appears over the app you are working in.
- **Confirmation**: when a slice runs, a short text appears for a moment under the menu (above it if the screen is full): for example **Selection copied**, **Undone**, **Pasted**, **Zoomed in**. Slices you made yourself say **{name} done**. If the action did not work, it says **{name} did not work** (and the reason is in the app log). The text never takes the keyboard or the mouse; it is in the app's language.
- In **Scribble**, the radial menu's **Undo** and **Redo** undo and redo your strokes (so does **Cmd+Z** and **Cmd+Shift+Z**), so you can try the menu without a drawing app. **Copy** copies the drawing; Paste, Cut, Select all and Zoom only say that they work in your drawing app.
- Menu editor: click a slice, give it a **Name** and choose **What it does**: **Keystroke** (**Set keystroke...**), **Mouse click** (Left, Right, Middle or Double Click), **Submenu** (8 more slices; **Edit submenu** opens it, up to 3 levels), **Open an app** (**Choose app...**), or **Nothing** (the slice closes the menu). **Clear slice** empties one slice, **Reset menu** brings back the starting menu (Undo, Redo, Copy, Paste, Cut, Select all, Zoom out, Zoom in). **Menu size**: Small to Large (1 to 10). Move the slider, or click the number box next to it and type a size (press Enter or click elsewhere; Up and Down change it by 1). Large is the biggest the menu gets, 320 points across; a menu saved with an older, larger size is shown and used at Large. The ring on the left changes size live while you move the slider, so you see how big the menu will be. The editor fits the window: in a small window the ring becomes smaller instead of being cut off, and nothing hides behind the size and transparency rows. **Menu transparency** (0 to 60%, 0 is solid) makes the whole menu see-through, names and icons included, so you can see your work behind it: 40% unless you change it. It stops at 60% so the slice names stay readable even over a white page. A menu that is already open on screen changes at once while you move the slider. Move the slider or click the number box and type a value (press Enter or click elsewhere; Up and Down change it by 1), and the ring on the left shows it live. The short texts next to the menu (the pencil hint, "Selection copied") are always solid. **Reset menu** puts back the starting menu, size 10 and transparency 40%.
- Each button keeps its own menu, and each application can have its own (Application row). The menus are saved with your tablet settings, so Save, Save as default, Revert and the settings backup include them.
- **Settings › System › Radial menu** switches every radial menu off or on (on by default). A new tablet and **Restore factory settings** start with the Radial menu on pen button 2.
- New in Version 26 and not yet tried on a real Mac.

Tablet › Functions › Touch ring

- **Touch Ring** (a tablet with one ring), **Touch Rings** (two rings, for example Cintiq 24HD), or **Touch Strip** / **Touch Strips** (tablets with touch strips, for example Intuos3 or Cintiq 22HD): an Off / On switch, On. Off pauses the ring or strip actions without deleting them. With two rings or strips, each one also has its own Off / On switch next to its name; it works only while the main switch is On, and the main switch never changes it.
- **Touch Ring modes**: On. "4 modes. Press the ring's centre button to switch."
- **Show touch ring setting (on-screen mode display)**: On. Shows the mode name when you switch.

- The dial follows the ring live: the dot sits under your finger. The angle and turn direction show under the ring, for example "0° · Clockwise". 12 o'clock is 0° and 3 o'clock is 90°.
- The active mode is highlighted; its number is lit, centred, and also shows on the centre button.



Touch ring in use

- On-screen centre button: moves the highlight to the next mode so you can edit it; it doesn't change the mode the tablet uses. Only the tablet's own centre button switches the mode.
- Per mode: name, **On**, **Function** (Keystroke..., **Scroll**, or the experimental smooth actions), **Speed** (Slow to Fast, slider or typed), and the **Clockwise** and **Anticlockwise** keys.
- **Speed**, the same scale for every function: 1 acts once every 180° of ring, 50 about every 30°, 100 on every ring step. For **Smooth rotate**, **Smooth brush size** and **Smooth hardness** in Photoshop, the Speed sets how far the canvas turns or the brush changes.
- Where the smooth actions work: **Smooth rotate**, **Smooth brush size** and **Smooth hardness** in Photoshop; **Smooth zoom** (Option + scroll wheel) in Photoshop and Affinity; **Smooth rotate** in Affinity uses ⌘ + scroll wheel, so first turn on **Enable canvas rotation with ⌘+scroll wheel** in Affinity's **Settings › Tools**. In any other app, a smooth mode sends its **Clockwise** and **Anticlockwise** keys at its Speed. If Photoshop moves the canvas up and down instead of zooming, untick **Zoom with Scroll Wheel** in Photoshop's **Settings › Tools**, or use **Keystroke** with ⌘= / ⌘−.
- **Scroll** scrolls like a mouse wheel in every app: clockwise scrolls down, anticlockwise scrolls up (as on Wacom's driver). The Speed sets how often it scrolls: 70, the default, is about one wheel notch every 15° of ring.
- With an app selected in the **Application** row, the ring settings you change are that app's. Select **All** to change them for every other app.
- Coming from Version 16 BETA 1 or earlier: the ring modes ran backwards there (a clockwise turn zoomed out). The app turns them the right way round when it opens; click **Save** once to keep it.

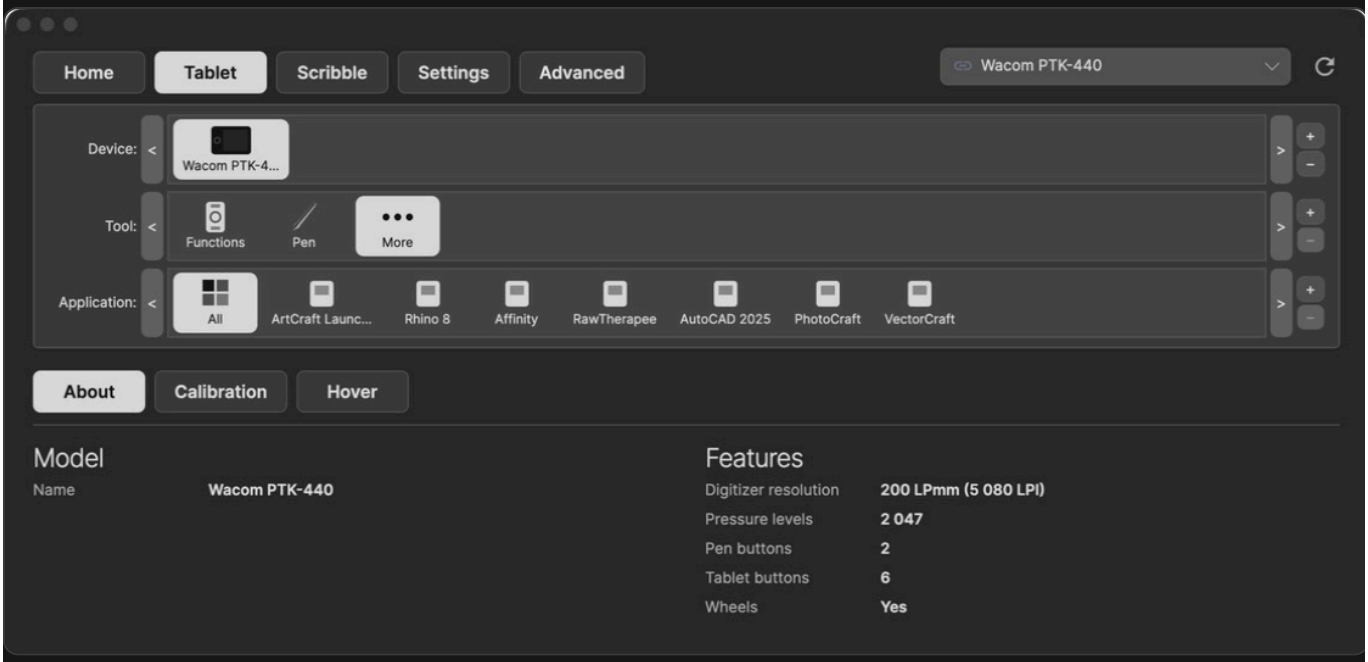
- **Default** restores the four modes:

Mode	Clockwise	Anticlockwise	Every
Rotate	Option+F13	Option+F14	10°
Zoom	Cmd+=	Cmd+–	30°
Brush size	]	[	8°
Brush hardness	Shift+]	Shift+[	60°

Touch strips (Intuos3, Cintiq 21UX, Cintiq 12WX and Cintiq 22HD; new in Version 16, not yet tested on these tablets): the page shows each strip, **Touch strip** or **Left touch strip** and **Right touch strip**, with an **Up** and a **Down** row instead of the ring. Slide your finger up or down the strip to send that row's keys. Strips have no centre button, so they have no ring modes.

Tablet › More

- **about**: the tablet's model and features: digitiser resolution, pressure levels, pen buttons, **Tablet buttons** and wheels.

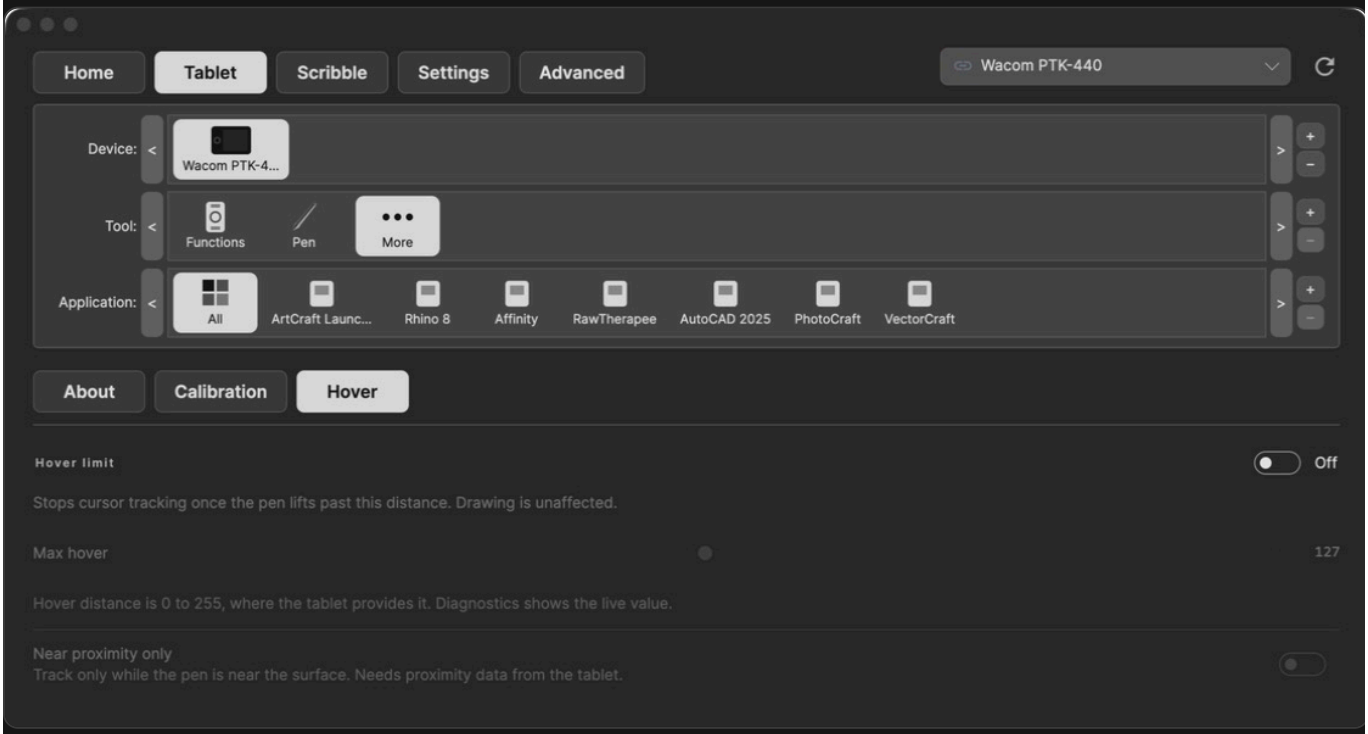


More › About

- **calibration**: **Start** shows full-screen targets; tap each, then **Apply**. **More calibration actions**: **View report…**, **Export calibration…**, **Import calibration…**, **Clear calibration**. The on/off switch turns the calibration correction off and on, so you can compare. Calibrate only if the pointer sits away from the nib.
- **hover** (below): hover limit, off by default; 127 when first switched on (0 to 255). The pen stops moving the cursor when it is higher above the tablet than this limit.
- **filters**: filters from other OpenTabletDriver plugins on this tablet, for example **Antichatter** or **Radial Follow** smoothing, which can calm a shaky pointer. Each filter has an **Off** / **On** switch (Off on the left, On on the right). Turn one on to use it with this app; if the pen starts to feel odd, turn it off again. A filter you turn on is remembered and is not switched off by the app. For simple smoothing while the pen touches, try **Pen › Position smoothing** first. If the profile has no filters, the page says

No filters configured. A **Legacy** mark means a leftover from an older plugin: it has no effect and is removed automatically. New in Version 26.

- **json**: the profile as the driver stores it.



More › Hover

Finger touch (Intuos Pro M, PTH-651)

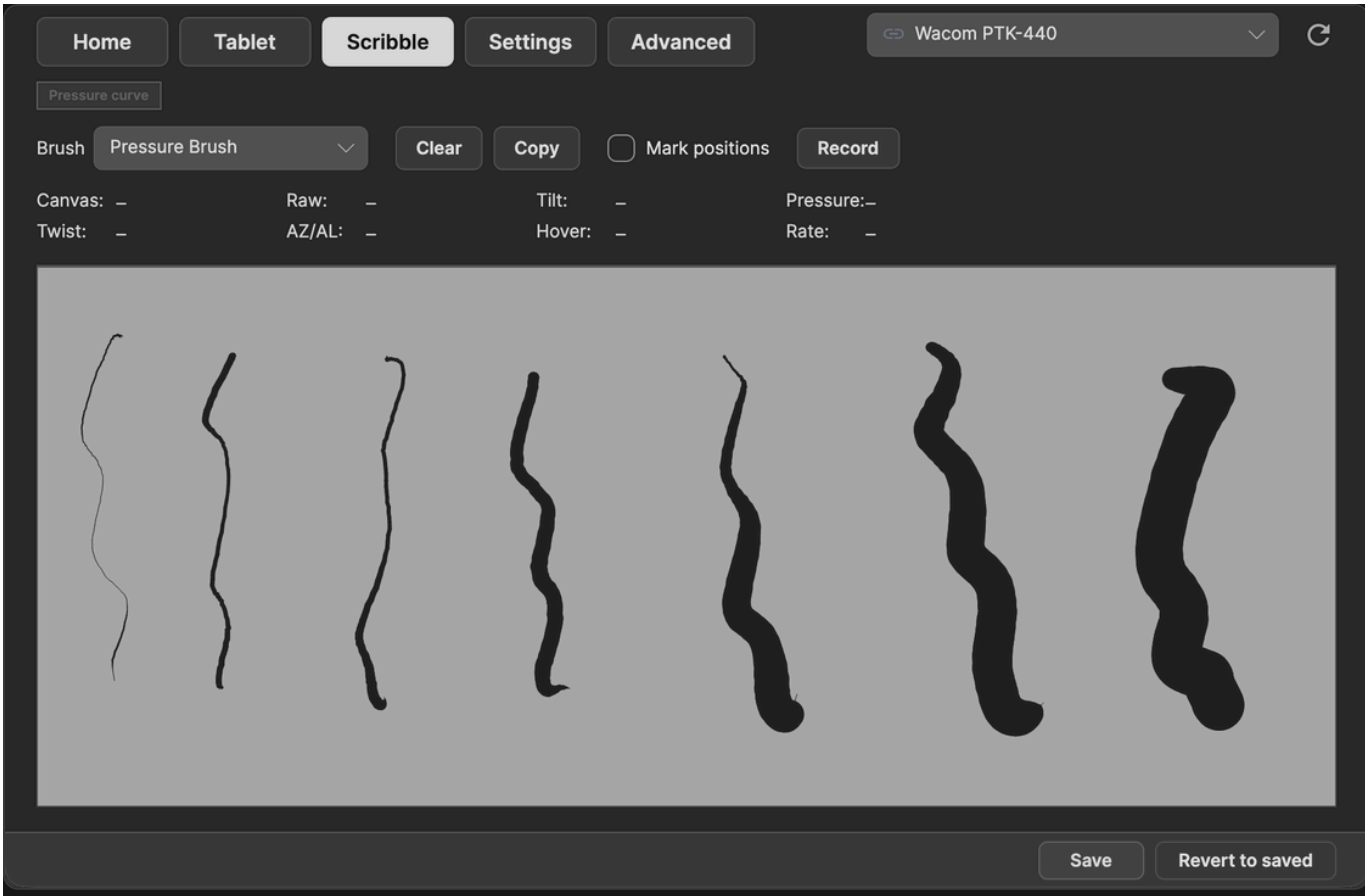
On the Intuos Pro M (PTH-651), finger touch works like a Mac trackpad. Switch it on or off with **Touch trackpad** on **Tablet › More › about**.

- One finger moves the pointer.
- Two fingers scroll.
- Tap to click. Two quick taps double-click.
- Tap, then touch again and move to drag. Lift your finger to let go.
- Tap with two fingers to right-click.
- A held click is released when the driver stops the touch filter (for example when the tablet is unplugged).

Touch is ignored while the pen is near the tablet, so a resting hand doesn't move the pointer.

Scribble

A test canvas with a precise crosshair cursor. If the canvas says "Drawing is off because the pen isn't set to follow the screen", click **Use pen on screen**: Movement becomes **Normal (Absolute)** and, if needed, the pen is mapped to all displays. The same settings are in **Tablet › Pen › Movement** and **Tablet › Mapping**. Draws with the processed pressure, so the curve, Disable pen tip and the Manual Pressure are visible.



Scribble

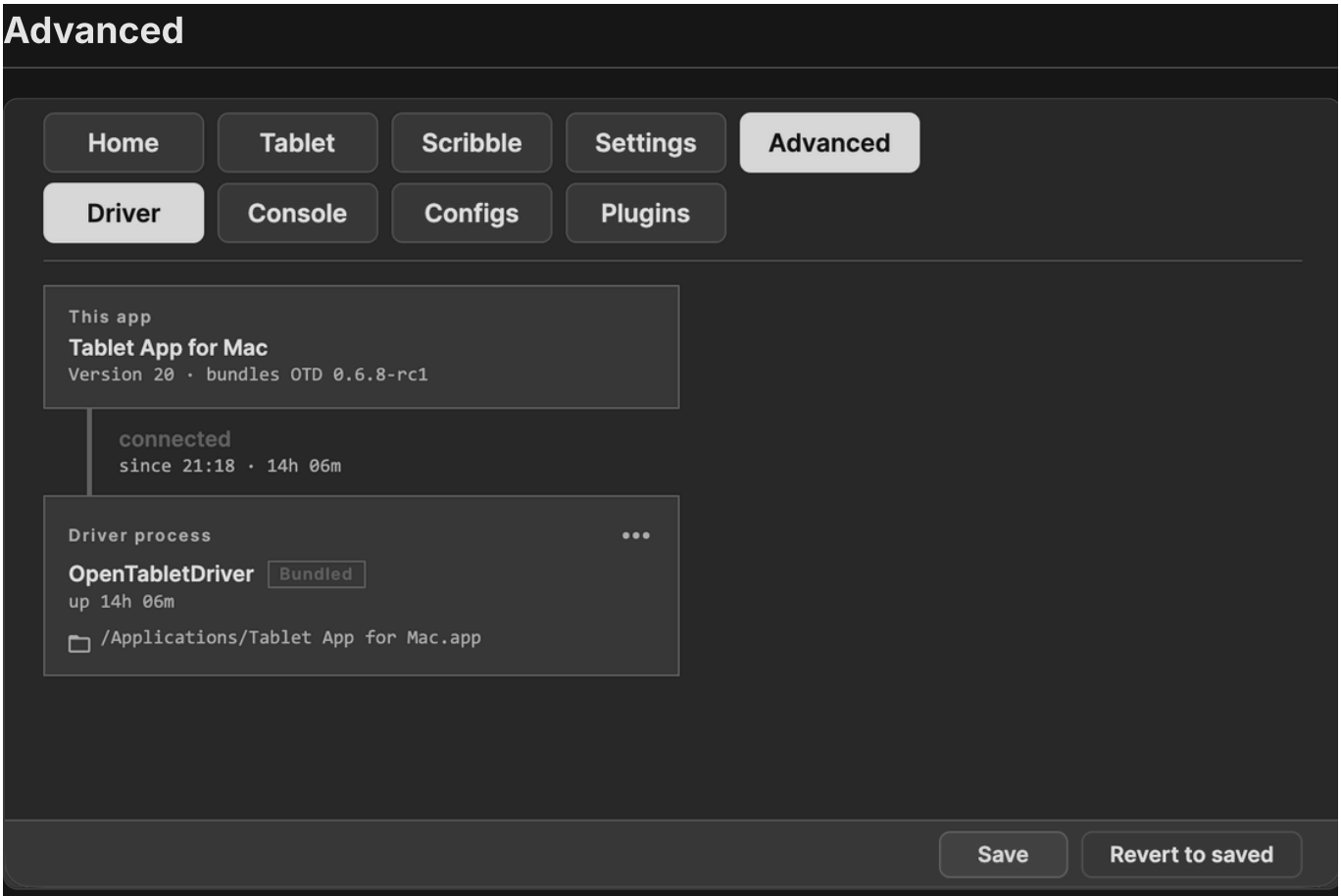
Mark positions draws a dot for each position the tablet reports. **Clear**, **Copy**. **Cmd+Z** undoes the last stroke (or a Clear) and **Cmd+Shift+Z** does it again; the radial menu's Undo and Redo send the same keys. **Record** and **Stop** save a stroke recording.

Settings

- **Theme**: **Themes** (Graphite, Silver, Charcoal, Rose, Burgundy, Custom, System; default Graphite), brightness, **Backdrops** (Solid colour, Generated gradient, **Add glow**, **Choose image…**), **Colours** (Highlight colour, Card colour). **Reset to defaults**.
- **Hotkeys**: global shortcuts for tablet actions and **Load a preset**. **Assign…**, **Clear**. Default: not set.
- **Presets**: see Presets and saving.
- **System › Status light** (shown only while an Intuos4 is connected): **Light up the status light when the pen touches** is on by default. The tablet's status light stays dim and gets bright while the pen touches, as it did with the Wacom driver. Switch it off for one steady brightness. The setting is sent to the tablet once when it connects, not while you draw.
- **System › ExpressKey screens** (shown only while an Intuos4 Medium, Large, Extra Large or Wireless is connected by cable): **Show what each ExpressKey does on its screen** is on by default. Each small screen beside an ExpressKey shows that key's action, for example "Shift Cmd / Z" or "Right click". A key that does nothing stays dark. The words follow your settings, including per-app settings. Switch it off and the screens stay dark. New in Version 26 and not yet tried on a real tablet with screens.
- **System › Radial menu**: **Show the radial menu** is on by default. It is for pen buttons and ExpressKeys set to Radial menu (see Tablet › Functions › ExpressKeys › Radial menu). Off: those buttons do nothing.

- **System › Settings backup**: **Export settings…** saves all your settings in one file: tablets, pens and per-pen settings, presets, applications, Touch Ring modes, calibration and app settings. The suggested name is the tablet model and the date, for example `Intuos4PTK440_30Oct26.tabletsettings` (`TabletApp_30Oct26` when no tablet is connected); you can type another name. Serial numbers and your user name are left out, so you can email the file to someone else or keep it for a new Mac. **Import settings…** opens a file and lists what would change (**New**, **Changed**, **Same**) before anything happens; click **Apply these settings** or **Cancel**. Your current settings are backed up first. Then quit and reopen the app.
- **Settings files in Finder**: a `.tabletsettings` file shows the app icon on a page. Double-click it to open Tablet App for Mac at **Settings › System** with its Import preview; nothing changes until you click **Apply these settings**.
- **App menu**: the **Tablet App for Mac** menu at the top left of the screen has **About Tablet App for Mac** (opens Home, with the version and links), **Report a problem or send a recommendation…** (see Report a problem or send a recommendation), **Export settings…** and **Import settings…** (the same as the buttons in Settings › System; results show in the main window). The pen menu in the menu bar has them too.
- **System › Automatic backups**: when a new version starts for the first time, the app backs up all your settings by itself, and it does the same before every import. The last 5 are kept. **Preview…** shows what bringing one back would change; **Show in Finder** opens the folder.
- **System › Diagnostic file**: **Create diagnostic file** saves one zip on your Desktop with a summary (app, driver and macOS versions, connected tablets, other tablet drivers found, and your mice and keyboards: name, IDs, connection and driver), the app and driver logs and your settings. Serial numbers, Bluetooth addresses and your user name are removed. The path shows under the button; attach the zip to a GitHub issue. The same button is on **Settings › Troubleshooting** (**Diagnostic report**) and on **Advanced › Diagnostics**.
- **System**: **Start at login**. Switch on **Start automatically when I log in** to have the app start by itself when you log in to your Mac, with only the pen icon in the menu bar. **Open Login Items…** opens the same setting in macOS: System Settings › General › Login Items.
- **Troubleshooting**: a page under Settings with quick fixes when the tablet stops responding, a setting will not stick, or you need to send a report. **Restart driver** stops the tablet driver and starts it again; use this when the pen stops moving or a tablet is not detected. **Diagnostic report** has **Create diagnostic file** (the same zip as **System › Diagnostic file**; **Show in Finder** appears once it is saved). **Reset permissions** clears this app's Input Monitoring and Accessibility entries so macOS will ask again.

Advanced



Advanced › Driver

- **Driver**: the **Driver process** card, with **Start**, **Restart** and **Stop** in its ⋯ menu; **Open OpenTabletDriver's own window**; **Open the folder holding this driver**.
- **Plugins**: **Rescan plugin folder**, **Open plugin folder**.
- **Configs** (tablet configs): **Check for more configs**, **Install**, **View**.
- **Console**: severity filter, text filter, **Auto-scroll** (on), copy as text, Markdown or HTML, **Clear**.
- **Diagnostics** (shown when **Settings › Dev** turns it on): **Start** and **Stop** live reports, and **Create diagnostic file**.

About and Options

About shows the version and links: **Get help** (report a bug, ask a question or send feedback on GitHub), **Supported tablets**, **Source code**, **Releases**, **User manual**, **Credits and licences**, **Feedback** (opens Report a problem or send a recommendation, below). **Options…** opens Settings.

Report a problem or send a recommendation

You can open the same report from three places:

- the app window: **Feedback** on **Home**, or **Report a problem or send a recommendation…** at the bottom of the Tablet page;
- the pen icon menu in the menu bar (top right);
- the **Tablet App for Mac** menu (top left).

The report opens inside the app window:

- Choose **A problem** or **A recommendation**.
- Write what happened, or your idea (you can leave it empty).
- A picture of the app window, as it was just before the report opened, is added. Untick **Add this picture of the app window** to leave it out. **Add screenshots...** adds more pictures (up to 10 in all).
- Press **Send with file** or **Send with GitHub account**. Both make one file with your text, your pictures and the app and driver logs. Serial numbers and your user name are removed from the logs. Pictures are sent as they are, so check them first.
- **Send with file** needs no account. It asks where to save the file (the Desktop is suggested). Then the report shows where the file is. Click **Open upload page** and add this file. The page asks for your name and email (Dropbox's rule) — only the Tablet App for Mac team sees them; no Dropbox account is needed. Your text and pictures are already in the file. There is no Show in Finder button.
- **Your email** (optional, near the top of the report): "Leave your email so we can help you better in fixing your issue". It is put in the file only with **Send with file**, so we can reply; **Send with GitHub account** never includes it. You can leave it empty.
- **Send with GitHub account** needs a free GitHub account. It saves the file on your Desktop, shows it in Finder and opens a new GitHub issue with your text filled in. Drag the file into it and press **Create**.

Cancel closes the report and sends nothing.

Presets and saving

The footer of the tablet page has **Save**, **Save as default**, **Revert to saved**, **Revert to default** and **Restore factory settings**. Changes apply at once.

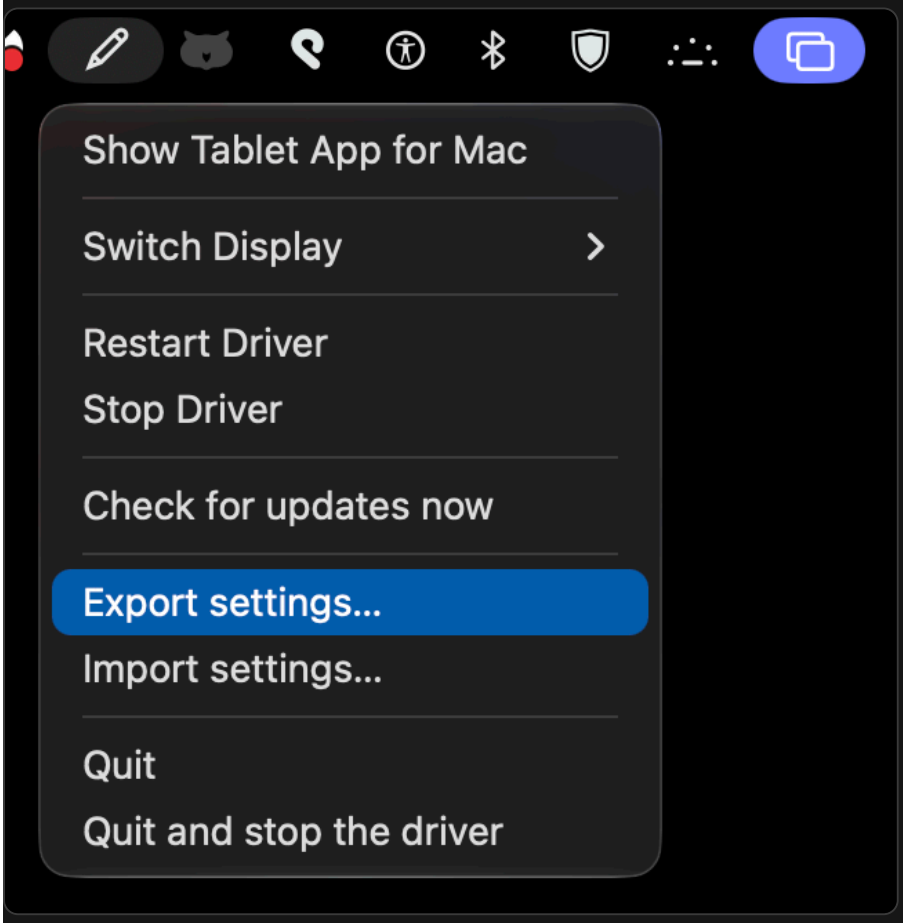
- **Save** writes the settings so they survive a driver restart (Cmd+S). **Revert to saved** goes back to the last save, after asking **Revert to saved settings?**
- **Save as default** stores the current settings as your own default. They survive a restart, and **Revert to default** brings them back. This includes each ExpressKey's and each Touch Ring's own On/Off, and the app's own switches.
- **Revert to default** replaces the current settings with your saved default (or the factory settings if you have not saved one) and saves them, after asking **Revert to default?** Unsaved edits will be lost. If you have not saved your own default, the tooltip says this restores the factory settings. If the settings already match, the button is disabled (**Already matching your saved default.**). Without a saved default it does the same as **Restore factory settings**, including the Radial menu on pen button 2.
- **Restore factory settings** resets everything to the original factory defaults, including each ExpressKey's and each Touch Ring's own On/Off. It asks first: **Restore factory settings?** Your own saved default is kept, so you can still use **Revert to default** afterwards. After a factory restore the Radial menu is on **pen button 2** (and **Show the radial menu** is switched on); pen button 1 and the other buttons keep their factory settings.
- After a shutdown or crash with unsaved changes, the app offers the snapshot again at the next launch.
- **Save as preset** stores the whole configuration under a name. Preset ⋯: **Update from current settings**, **Duplicate**, **Rename...**, **Delete**. **Load** applies it.

Confirmation messages

Buttons that complete an action show a large on-screen message, the same size and style as the Touch Ring mode display (for example when you switch ring mode). It appears in the centre of the window, shows the app name and a short past-tense line such as **Settings saved**, **Saved as default**, **Reverted to default**, **Factory settings restored**, **Settings reverted**, **Driver restarted** or **Diagnostic file created**, then fades away. Switches, Cancel, and buttons that only open a menu, dialog or folder do not show it. New in Version 26.

The pen menu

The pen icon in the menu bar at the top of the screen shows that Tablet App for Mac is running. Click it to open its menu.



The pen icon in the menu bar with its menu open

The **driver** is the background part of the app that reads the pen and moves the pointer. It keeps working while the window is closed.

- **Show Tablet App for Mac** opens the app's window.
- **Switch Display** chooses which screen the tablet draws on, when you have more than one screen.
- **Restart Driver** stops the background part and starts it again. Try this first if the pen stops responding.
- **Stop Driver** stops the background part, so the pen stops working until you start it again. While it is stopped, the menu shows **Start Driver** instead.
- **Check for updates now** checks for a new version (see Updating).

- **Report a problem or send a recommendation…** opens the app's window with the report in it (see Report a problem or send a recommendation).
- **Export settings…** and **Import settings…** open the app at Settings › System and do the same as the buttons there.
- **Quit** closes the app and removes the pen icon. The background part keeps running, so the pen still works with the settings you saved.
- **Quit and stop the driver** closes the app and stops the background part too, so the pen stops working until you open the app again.

Quitting

- **Cmd+Q** quits the app straight away, without asking. Unsaved changes are kept and offered at the next launch. If the app started the driver, the driver stops too, so the pen stops working until you open the app again.
- To close only the window, click its red close button. The app stays in the menu bar and the tablet keeps working.
- **Quit** in the pen menu closes the app; **Quit and stop the driver** also stops the pen (see The pen menu). With unsaved changes it asks "Save changes before quitting?": **Cancel** keeps the app open, **Don't Save** quits without saving, **Save** saves and quits.
- Quitting also happens at shutdown and logout; unsaved changes are then kept and offered at the next launch.

Tested system and tablet

macOS 27.0.1 on Apple silicon, Wacom Intuos4 Small (PTK-440). Nothing else has been tested.

Supported tablets

Supported tablets (in **About**) lists every tablet the driver knows, with its support level (**Supported**, **Has Quirks**, **Questionable** or **Missing Features**) and notes. The Wacom tablets are also listed on the website: https://digitalgroceries.github.io/tablet-app-for-mac/tablets/

Version 16 adds the following. None of it has been tested on these tablets yet, so please tell us how it works (**Feedback** on **Home**):

- Intuos Pro (PTH-460, PTH-660, PTH-860): the Touch Ring turns the right way and its zero is at the left, like other Wacom rings.
- Intuos3 (PTZ-430, PTZ-431W, PTZ-630, PTZ-631W, PTZ-930, PTZ-1230, PTZ-1231W), Cintiq 21UX (DTZ-2100 and DTK-2100), Cintiq 12WX (DTZ-1200W) and Cintiq 22HD (DTK-2200, DTH-2200): touch strips (see Touch ring).
- Cintiq 13HD (DTK-1300, DTH-1300): the centre button of the Rocker Ring, as ExpressKey 9.
- Bamboo Fun (CTE-450, CTE-650): the Touch Ring.
- Wacom CTK-4120: newly listed.

Version 19 adds: Cintiq 21UX (DTK-2100) and Cintiq 22HD (DTK-2200, DTH-2200): the ExpressKeys are read the way the Linux Wacom driver reads them, so each key sends its own setting. If you set up

these keys in an earlier version, check them once on **Tablet › Functions › ExpressKeys**; the app shows a note in the main window. Not yet tested on these tablets.

Wacom driver conflict

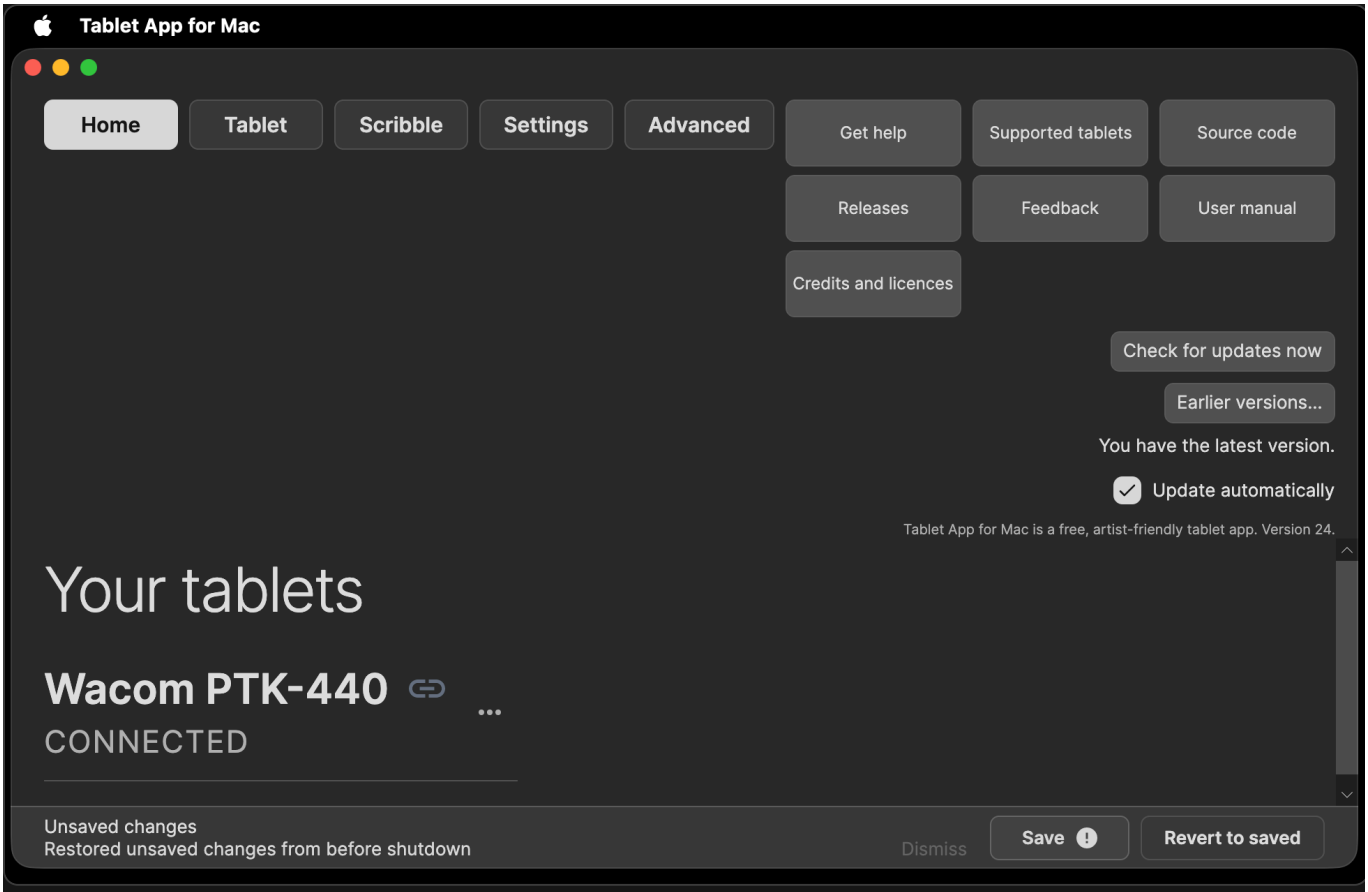
The Wacom driver and OpenTabletDriver cannot both use the tablet. Quit or uninstall the Wacom driver before using this app. Home shows a warning while it is running. The app also checks which programs are running every 15 seconds and shows **Another tablet driver is running** on **Home** when it finds the Wacom driver (WacomTabletDriver, TabletDriver, Wacom_IOManager, WacomTabletSpringboard, DataStoreMgr), the Xencelabs driver, or a second OpenTabletDriver daemon.

Updating

Version 19: messages and dialogs now open inside the main window, not as separate windows.

Permissions: from Version 18 on, updates keep both permissions; there is nothing to do. **Updating from Version 17 or older:** once, in System Settings › Privacy & Security › **Input Monitoring** and **Device Control and Data Access** (called **Accessibility** on older macOS), remove the old Tablet App for Mac entries with **–**, add the app with **+** and switch it on.

- The app checks for updates every time it starts. When there is a new stable version, it asks **Update now?** Click **Update now** and the app downloads it, checks it, installs it and opens again by itself.
- To check any time, click **Check for updates now** on **Home** (top right, under the About links). When there is a choice, Home shows **Install Version N** (the newest stable version) and **Try Version N BETA M** (a BETA: new features, not tested yet). While you use a BETA, **Previous Version** returns you to the stable version (the full name, **Go back to Version N**, is in the tooltip).
- **Update automatically** is an optional setting just below it. It is off unless you turn it on. When it is on, the app downloads a new stable version by itself, then asks for OK before installing. It never installs a BETA by itself.
- To go back to an earlier version, click **Earlier versions…** on **Home** and choose one of the two most recent stable versions older than the one you have. This works from a stable version and from a BETA. Your settings stay.



Home on Version 24: You have the latest version. Check for updates now, Earlier versions..., and Update automatically are on the right.

- The two permissions are asked for only at the first installation. Updates from Version 18 on keep them.
- **Coming from Version 6:** install Version 7 or later by hand once (see Install and first launch). Then do the one-time step for Version 17 or older above.
- **Permission switches turn themselves off?** macOS is still holding the entries of Version 17 or older. Make sure the app is in **Applications** (not opened from the disk image or Downloads). On **Home**, click **Reset permissions**. Then in System Settings › Privacy & Security › **Input Monitoring** and **Device Control and Data Access** (called **Accessibility** on older macOS): select every old Tablet App for Mac entry and remove it with **–**, then click **+**, add Tablet App for Mac from Applications, switch it on, and restart the app. In Terminal the same reset is `tccutil reset ListenEvent com.freetabletapp.mac` and `tccutil reset Accessibility com.freetabletapp.mac`.
- **By hand, if you prefer:** quit the app, replace it in Applications with the new version, and open it.

Going back to an earlier build

Click **Earlier versions...** on **Home** (Version 15 and later), or download an earlier build from Releases and replace the app. Settings are kept. Going back to Version 17 or older needs the one-time – then + step under Updating.

Uninstalling

- Quit from the menu bar.
- Delete the app from Applications.

- Remove its entries from **Input Monitoring** and **Accessibility** (on macOS 27: **Device Control and Data Access**) with **–**.
- Remove its Login Item if you added one (System Settings › General › Login Items).
- Optional: delete its settings folder, ~/Library/Application Support/Tablet App for Mac.

Credits and licences

Tablet App for Mac is a modified version of OpenTabletArtist by TheSevenPens (GPL-3.0) and uses OpenTabletDriver (LGPL-3.0). The full list of packages and licence texts is on the Credits and licences page. Some features (settings backup, the diagnostic file and the running-driver check) use ideas from MockTab by Cyzor (GPL-3).

Glossary

- **Tip Feel**: the pressure curve, from Soft to Firm.
- **Double Click Fix**: how far the pen tip may wobble during a click before it counts as a drag (Off = 0, Default 50 = 1 mm, 100 = 2 mm).
- **Double Click**: a pen-button or ExpressKey action that posts a left-button double-click at the cursor.
- **Touch Ring modes**: up to four sets of ring actions, switched with the centre button.
- **Touch strip**: the finger strip on Intuos3 and older Cintiqs. It works like the ring, with Up and Down.
- **Preset**: a named copy of the whole configuration.
- **Application row**: per-app settings; **All** applies everywhere else.
- **Shared with Pen**: an Eraser setting that is the same setting as on the Pen tab.
- **Driver**: the background part of the app that reads the pen and moves the pointer, built on OpenTabletDriver.
- **BETA**: a new version that is not tested yet. You can go back to the stable version at any time.

Not written here

The per-app notes (Photoshop, Affinity, PhotoCraft) are written separately. Per-app shortcuts: not yet tested.